

Use of natural family planning methods go up



The usage of short-term acting methods increased from 23 per cent in 2019 to 27 per cent in 2020 while that of the long-term methods reduced from 20 to 19 per cent in the same year.

What you need to know:

- In 2014, only one per cent of women were using the traditional methods while in 2020 the number rose to four per cent.
- The uptake of modern methods of contraceptives increased from 56 per cent in 2019 to 61 per cent in 2020 in married women and from 40 to 46 percent in all women.
- Natural methods have no side effects. With these methods, one is required to track their fertility peak, which is when they are most likely to get pregnant.

The percentage of women using a natural method of family planning in Kenya has increased.

Over the past four years, the number has gone up from one to four per cent. This is as the use of modern contraceptives in married women increased by five per cent.

Natural or traditional family planning is a form of birth control that does not involve pills or devices.

In 2014, only one per cent of women were using the traditional methods while in 2020 the number rose to four per cent.

The uptake of modern methods of contraceptives increased from 56 per cent in 2019 to 61 per cent in 2020 in married women and from 40 to 46 percent in all women.

Releasing data during an event on family planning by Performance Monitoring for Action (PMA) Kenya, Prof Peter Gichangi, the principal investigator, PMA, said the traditional methods were equally important since there were individuals who would still benefit from them.

“This is usually an individual choice. If the couples can agree to use either safe periods or the withdrawal method, then it is okay,” said Prof Gichangi, who is also a lead researcher International Centre for Reproductive Health Kenya (ICRH-K).

Natural methods have no side effects. With these methods, one is required to track their fertility peak, which is when they are most likely to get pregnant.

The traditional methods of contraception include the lactational amenorrhoea method, coitus interrupts (withdrawal method), calendar method or rhythm method, cervical mucus method and abstinence.

Given that more women are aware of modern methods and the uptake is increasing, the few could be due to fear of side effects.

Regular periods

However, according to the Centres for Disease Control (CDC), traditional methods are not as effective as other methods of birth control. It says their failure rate is 24 per cent, which means that about two in 10 women who use natural family planning will get pregnant.

“You need to be careful, be diligent, and have plenty of self-control to practise natural family planning. You have to follow instructions completely to be successful. If you do not have regular periods, then it is not advisable to practise this method of family planning,” states CDC.

Dr Gilchrist Lokoel, the director of medical services at Turkana County, added that in some parts of the world culture has made it difficult for some women to use modern family planning but this is because they do not know its benefits.

“Traditional methods are accepted though they are not as effective as modern ones and they cannot be used by everyone. You need to study your body carefully. To avoid unintended pregnancies, it is advisable to decide on one method that is most convenient for you,” said Dr Lokoel, who is also a surgeon.

The survey, done between November and December last year in 11 counties (Nairobi, Kilifi, Nandi, Nyamira, Kiambu, Bungoma, Siaya, Kericho, Kitui, Kakamega and West Pokot), also pointed out that the increase in the uptake of the modern methods reduced unintended pregnancies from 42 per cent in 2019 to 37 per cent in 2020.

The study comes out at a time when health and development players had raised concerns about the rise in unintended pregnancies due to the lockdowns, curfews and disruptions in health services by the pandemic.

The usage of short-term acting methods increased from 23 per cent in 2019 to 27 per cent in 2020 while that of the long-term methods reduced from 20 to 19 per cent in the same year with the demand satisfied by modern methods increasing from 74 to 76 per cent.

This means out of 10 women that needed modern family planning in 2020, eight were able to get the methods. However, stockouts still remain a problem in public and private health facilities.

“With time there have been changes in facilities reporting not offering the services and most of them are dispensaries. This could be because of personnel and even materials and stockouts,” said Prof Gichangi.

Implants stockouts

The report also indicated that married women use modern contraceptives more than their unmarried counterparts, 58 per cent in 2019 and 62 per cent in 2020, as compared to 56 and 61 per cent in that very period for the latter group.

However, unmarried women prefer short-acting methods like emergency contraception, while their married counterparts chose long-acting methods. The most popular method for unmarried women, the survey showed, is male condoms (29 per cent), injectables and implants (both at 26 per cent). The married woman, on the other hand, preferred injectables (39 per cent) and implants (37 per cent).

The stockout of intrauterine devices in public facilities was found to have increased from seven per cent in 2019 to 11 per cent in 2020. Implants stockout remained almost constant, while the stockout of injectables, the most used method, reduced from 13 to seven per cent between 2019 and 2020.

Out of the 822 public hospitals surveyed, 70 per cent reported ordering but not receiving the shipment, 10 per cent increased consumption, seven per cent ordered but did not receive the right quantity while seven per cent did not place an order for shipment.

“We need to look at where the disconnect occurs. Why would you order but not receive the shipment? It is clear there is a disconnect and we need to see a change since it is going to erode the gains,” he said.

Prof Gichangi also said despite the interruption of many services in the country due to Covid-19, very few women, about four per cent, reported disruption. Most of those affected are in the lowest cadres.

The report also said only three per cent of facilities were closed and very few were closed for more than one month, 19 per cent were closed for one week and 23 per cent for one to two weeks.

Source:<https://nation.africa/kenya/healthy-nation/use-of-natural-family-planning-methods-go-up-3341758>

By: [Angela Oketch](#)

Nation Media Group

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Uptake of contraceptives rose by five per cent — survey

Most popular method for the unmarried women was male condoms at 29 per cent



Contraception is for both partners

In Summary

- The survey showed the uptake increased to 61 per cent in 2020 from 56 per cent in 2019.
- It was conducted by Performance Monitoring for Action and released on Thursday.

The number of women using modern birth control methods increased by five per cent in 2020, the latest survey shows.

The survey showed the uptake increased to 61 per cent in 2020 from 56 per cent in 2019. It was conducted by Performance Monitoring for Action and released on Thursday.

Information was collected from more than 9,000 women in 11 counties. Some 72 per cent reported receiving the contraceptive from a public service delivery point.

The counties include Kericho, Kitui, Nairobi, Nyamira, Siaya, West Pokot, Kilifi, Bungoma, Nandi, Kiambu and Migori.

The contraceptive use may have contributed to the decline in unintended pregnancies from 42 to 37 per cent in the same period, the survey shows.

Unmarried women were found to prefer short-acting methods like emergency contraceptive compared to their married counterparts.

Male condoms were most popular among unmarried women at 29 per cent followed by the injectable and implants at 26 per cent.

Married women preferred injectable and implants at 39 and 37 per cent respectively.

PMA Kenya principal investigator Peter Gichangi said there is a case for constantly collecting information, analysing and using it to inform how the state responds to family planning needs.

According to the survey, 37 per cent of pregnancies in 2020 were unintended, with 28 per cent being mistimed and 10 per cent unwanted.

“About three in every 10 non-users intend to use contraception in the next 12 months,” the report states.

The survey shows that public and private hospitals experienced stock-outs of family planning commodities. Seventy per cent of the hospitals said they ordered the commodities but did not receive them.

Ten per cent of the public hospitals reported that they experienced a dramatic increase in the demand for the family planning services. More than one per cent of the stock-outs were caused by Covid-19 disruptions.

Fifty-six per cent of women said they did not get comprehensive information on family planning services despite their willingness to plan and space childbirth.

They sought information on side effects or problems, where to go for help, alternative contraceptive methods and whether they could change current ones.

PMA Kenya senior technical advisor at ICRH Mary Thiong’o said the scarcity of information can lead to women not being satisfied, which can contribute to discontinuation and uniformed method switching.

“This therefore calls for strengthening the quality of care and counselling services by the service providers,” Thiong’o said.

Among women using a modern method that can be concealed, 15 per cent reported that their partner does not know that they are using contraception, the majority being adolescents, the report shows.

About five per cent of the married women reported that their partner tried to force or pressure them to become pregnant.

The study comes as health and development players have raised concerns about the rise in unintended pregnancies due to the lockdowns, curfews and disrupted services caused by the pandemic.

Source: <https://www.the-star.co.ke/news/2021-03-25-uptake-of-contraceptives-rose-by-five-per-cent-survey/>

MAGDALINE SAYA (edited by o. owino)

The Star

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Survey: Contraceptive uptake high despite Covid



The use of modern methods of contraceptives increased from 56 to 61 per cent in 2020, a new survey shows. The survey, which involved more than 9,000 women, also recorded a decline in unintended pregnancies from 42 to 37 per cent in the same period. It reveals that despite Covid-19 pandemic disrupting health services, women still sought emergency contraception, condoms, pills, injections and implants to delay pregnancy or space children.

“Unintended pregnancies have reduced from 42 per cent in 2019 to 37 per cent in 2020. In 2020, 28 per cent of the pregnancies were wanted later while 10 per cent of women wanted no more children,” the survey findings released yesterday say. Bungoma County had the highest use of contraceptives among married women in 2019 while Nandi had the highest number of married women using contraceptives in 2020. Nairobi County reported the highest increase in contraceptive uptake between 2019 and 2020.

The survey, conducted by Performance Monitoring for Action— a consortium that generates surveys monitoring key health indicators in nine countries in Africa and Asia— indicates that public and private hospitals continued to experience stock-outs. Majority of the hospitals (70 per cent) said they ordered the commodities but did not receive, which could be explained by interruption in the supply chain. Some (10 per cent) of the public hospitals reported that they experienced a dramatic increase in the demand for the family planning services. Generally, the report shows, Kenya meets 76 per cent of the demand for contraception by modern methods, a slight increase from 70 per cent in 2014, and 74 per cent in 2019. The survey revealed unmarried sexually active women are leading in uptake of contraceptives by 62.3 per cent compared to married women at 60.8 per cent.

The lead researcher of the survey Prof Peter Gichangi from the International Centre for Reproductive Health Kenya (ICRH-K) said the government of Kenya amid Covid-19, put in measures that ensured continuity of Sexual and Reproductive Health service provision.

Source: <https://epaper.peopledaily.co.ke/html5/reader/production/default.aspx?pubname=&edid=823c2b3a-a519-4530-b8b7-86b344c45a01>

People daily

By: BERNARD GITAU

Major Strides In Kenya's Use Of Contraceptives As Unintended Pregnancies Decline: Study Shows



NAIROBI, Kenya, March 25 – Kenya has made remarkable progress in the use of family planning, this is according to the Performance Monitoring for Action (PMA) survey conducted in 11 counties which revealed the use of modern contraceptive methods increased from 56 percent in 2019 to 61 percent in 2020.

The survey conducted between November and December 2020 by the International Centre for Reproductive Health (ICRH) in partnership with other government agencies noted that the increased use of contraceptives led to a decline in unintended pregnancy from 42 to 37 per cent over the same period.

“In 2020, 28 percent of the pregnancies were wanted later while 10 percent of women wanted no more children, about 3 in every 10 nonusers intend to use contraception in the next 12 months,” the survey noted.

The principal investigator of the survey Prof. Peter Gichangi noted that out of the 9,000 respondents interviewed, 44 percent reported having received information before using family planning methods while 57 percent said they did not receive any information.

“Such information includes possible side effects or problems, where to go if and when they experience them, other family planning methods available apart from the one they were getting, and whether they could change,” Mary Thiong’o, PMA Kenya Senior Technical Advisor at ICRH Kenya pointed out.

The survey, sponsored by the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, further noted that 78 percent of the respondents said they involved their partners before using the contraceptives while 22 percent who are mainly adolescents said they did not involve their partners.

“What the government has put in place is bearing fruits, we are able to see an increase in the use of contraceptives and decrease in unintended pregnancies, this is not one agency, it’s a multi-agency interaction which has seen the country make progress,” Prof. Gichangi said.

Despite the presence of COVID-19 which disrupted health services, the survey noted that women still sought emergency contraception, condoms, pills, injections, and implants to delay or space pregnancy.

“The most popular method for the unmarried woman, the survey showed is, male condoms (29 per cent), the injectable and implants (both at 26 per cent). The married woman on the other hand preferred injectable (39 per cent) and implants (37 per cent),” the survey added.

Seventy-two percent of public health facilities reported having sufficient stocks of Implants, 87 percent had sufficient pills stock while 90 pc had stocked male condoms

70 percent cited delay in delivery of stock as the reason for insufficient stocks while only 1.2 percent attributed their insufficient stock to the coronavirus pandemic.

During the COVID-19 period, 80 pc of health facilities said the family planning services were not affected while only 5.1 pc said they could not offer family planning services.

Source: <https://www.capitalfm.co.ke/news/2021/03/major-strides-in-kenyas-use-of-contraceptives-as-unintended-pregnancies-decline-study/>

By: [CAROLYNE TANUI](#)

Capital News

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Kenyan women did not want more kids during pandemic



The Covid-19 lockdown in 2020 provided couples with more free time than they were accustomed to.

This presented new challenges in the reproductive health department as many couples had more time for sex but few women wanted to get pregnant during the pandemic.

According to a survey released by Performance Monitoring for Action (PMA), a health consortium in Africa and Asia, only one in ten women wanted more children in 2020. This explains why the use of modern methods of contraceptives increased from 56 to 61 per cent in 2020 while [unintended pregnancy rates](#) declined from 42 to 37 percent.

There are differences in the way married and unmarried women seek to delay pregnancies. The survey found out that unmarried women prefer short-acting methods like emergency contraception, while married women chose long-acting methods.

The most popular method for unmarried women is male condoms at 29 per cent and injectables and implants both at 26 per cent. The married woman preferred injectables at 39 per cent and implants 37 per cent.

Of interest is that 15 per cent of women hide from their partners their choice of contraceptive method majority being adolescents while 22 per cent had not discussed the matter to delay or avoid pregnancy with their partner.

The report comes amid concerns of rising [teenage pregnancies](#) when Kenya was under partial lockdown and schools were closed in 2020.

The survey involved more than 9000 women and reveals that despite the disruptions in health services during the pandemic, women still sought emergency contraception, condoms, pills, injections and implants to delay or space pregnancy.

The lead researcher of the survey, Prof Peter Gichangi, from the International Centre for Reproductive Health Kenya (ICRH-K) said that the uptake of contraceptive use was backed by the government which put in measures that ensured continuity of Sexual and Reproductive Health service provision amid the Covid-19 pandemic.

Hospitals in Kenya experienced stock-outs of [contraceptives](#) with a majority at 70 per cent experiencing interrupted supply chain after making orders.

Kenya meets 76 per cent of the demand for contraception by modern methods, a slight increase from 70 per cent in 2014, and 74 per cent in 2019. According to the survey, married women use modern contraceptives more than their unmarried counterparts at 58 per cent in 2019 and 62 per cent in 2020, as compared to 56 and 61 per cent in that very period for the latter group.

With a disrupted health system during the pandemic, some women failed to get comprehensive information during [family planning](#) appointments including “possible side effects or problems, where to go if and when they experience them and other family planning methods” says Mary Thiong’o, PMA Kenya Senior Technical Advisor at ICRH Kenya.

In April 2020, the United Nations Population Fund (UNFP) had warned that there was a likelihood of increased early and unintended pregnancies but there was no concrete data to back up the claims.

Source: <https://www.standardmedia.co.ke/health/article/2001407438/kenyan-women-did-not-want-more-kids-during-pandemic>

Author: SAADA HASSAN

Standard Media

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Kenya Experiences 5% Increase in Uptake in Family Planning During Pandemic



A new survey shows that the use of family planning services in Kenya increased from 56% in 2019 to 61% despite curfews and lockdowns.

Kenya's family planning services experienced a 5% increase in the uptake of modern contraceptives at the height of the COVID-19 pandemic last year, possibly contributing to a decline in unwanted pregnancies in the country, a new [survey](#) has shown.

The survey, conducted by [Performance Monitoring for Action](#) (PMA), shows that the use of family planning services increased from 56% in 2019 to 61% in 2020 in married women and from 40% to 46% in all women, despite curfews and lockdowns.

The PMA generates surveys of key health indicators in nine countries in Africa and Asia, whose open-resource data is available for research, programme planning and policymaking.

The increased use of contraceptives is likely to have contributed to the decline of unintended pregnancies over the same period from 42% to 37%.

The survey – done between November and December last year in 11 counties (Nairobi, Kilifi, Nandi, Nyamira, Kiambu, Bungoma, Siaya, Kericho, Kitui, Kakamega and West Pokot) – also found that unmarried women prefer short-acting methods, while their married counterparts chose longer-acting methods.

The most popular method for unmarried women were male condoms (29%), injectables and implants (both at 26%). The married women, on the other hand, preferred injectables (39%) and implants (37%).

Family Planning is an Essential Service

Albert Ndwiga, the National Family Planning Program manager in the Ministry of Health, said family planning was an essential service and that the country “had to come up with guidelines quickly to ensure continued care in public health facilities during the pandemic”.

Family planning services are offered free of charge in public health facilities in Kenya. The guidelines were formulated in April last year, giving directives to facilities on how to protect the client and the service provider.

The government is now collaborating with the private sector, which supplies over a quarter of Kenyans (28%) with their family planning methods and commodities.

“Some may choose to get services from the private sector because of the convenience it offers to them, therefore reducing the burden on government-owned facilities,” Ndwiga said, adding that the health ministry has formulated a “total market approach” as a result.

The ministry has also actively engaged with communities “because issues around culture and religious beliefs have for a long time affected the uptake of family planning,” observes Josephine Kinyua, the director of Delivering Equitable and Sustainable Increases in Family Planning (DESIP) in Kenya, a program funded by the UK.

The DESIP program is implemented in 19 counties where the modern method contraceptive prevalence rate is less than 45%.

Commodity Financing and Economic Empowerment

Contraception methods



Ndwiga said family planning was going to be included as one of the government’s four key agendas, of which universal health coverage is a key component. The agendas include food security, affordable housing, manufacturing and affordable healthcare for all.

Kenya's government has committed to financing 100% of family planning commodities by 2023, and Ndwiga said they were now able to use health insurance to fund family planning.

Linking family planning with economic empowerment has contributed to increased uptake, according to Kinyua, who said some counties were now introducing bills geared towards funding maternal and child health alongside family planning.

“This will ensure that later, even if the programme is no longer there, some funding will be available to support maternal and child health,” she said.

However, cutting back on family planning commodities wastage would also go a long way towards saving money. This could be achieved by improving the quality of family planning services.

Ndwiga said an example of preventing wastage would be if a mother is counselled properly so that if she chooses to have a long-term contraceptive method, she will not change her mind after two months to have it removed.

“Because if that implant is meant to last for five years, but is removed after only two months, you lose four years and 10 months that it could have been used,” he says.

Data is Important to Inform Policies and Programs

Contraceptive use is known to be one of the determinants that influence fertility, according to Dr Anne Akonyo, senior lecturer and director of population studies at the University of Nairobi.

“It is one of the greatest inhibitors of fertility when used properly,” she explains.

Professor Peter Gichangi, the lead investigator of the PMA, says that the data collected should not just be used to inform programmes, policies and scientific publications, but as data sets that can be used for different purposes.

The data presented also posed some questions that need further investigating such as stock-outs for Intrauterine Devices (IUDs), which increased from 7% in 2019 to 11% in 2020.

Source: <https://healthpolicy-watch.news/kenya-experiences-5-uptake-in-family-planning/>

Author: [Geoffrey Kamadi](#)

Photo credits: Istock

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Use of modern contraceptive methods increases to 46pc

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The use of modern contraceptive methods among all women of reproductive age has increased to 46% in 2020, up from 38% in 2014, a new survey shows.

Kericho County has recorded 42% of the pregnancies as unintended in 2020. Survey and findings released Friday collected information from 834 women aged between 15-49 years in the County.

The survey was conducted by Performance Monitoring for Action (PMA) — a Consortium that generates surveys monitoring key health indicators in Kenya since 2014.

The survey also revealed an increase in the use of long acting methods to 17% in 2020 up from 12% in 2019.

Decisions on whether to use family planning method or not among partners measured during the survey reported that 58% of the respondents using FP agreed that it was a joint decision where as 85% women who were not using FP said that it was mainly their decision. Findings further revealed an increase in demand satisfied by modern methods at 75% up from 65% in 2014.

“Increase in demand has been realized through joint efforts between county and partners like The Challenge Initiative (TCI) who have supported outreaches to the communities. We have also trained staff in long term methods and counseled clients on the method mix such that they are able to choose what they need within reach.” Dr. Betty Langat County Director of Health -Kericho.

Survey & findings also showed that the county made positive progress in method availability within the in the past year with over 70% of the facilities not experiencing stock outs for the pills, injectable and male condoms in the last three months.

“The progress in the supply of FP commodities in the facilities was realized when the county was able to procure and order for commodities from KEMSA with support from Transforming Health Systems (THS) – World Bank. The staff were also trained in forecasting and quantification thereby ensuring that there is continued supply of the commodities in the facilities” said Dr. Betty Langat.

“The platform has been able to generate data over time that can support the county to make informed decisions and implement targeted interventions” said Mary Thiongo – PMA, Senior Technical Advisor in Kenya.

Source: <https://www.kbc.co.ke/use-of-modern-contraceptive-methods-increases-to-46pc/>

Christine Muchira

Kenya Broadcasting Cooperation

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